



# JAMES HARRIS

## SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

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*This version of my CV was published on 17 February 2026 — the latest version is always available at [cv.jamesharris.id.au](https://cv.jamesharris.id.au).*

### PROFILE

I'm a software engineer with **over 20 years experience** designing and building backend systems.

My experience spans **startups, small businesses, and larger organisations**. I have a proven track record of **team and project leadership**, taking ownership of architecture, process, and product direction. I seek environments where I can **guide platform direction and engineering practices**, preferring technical leadership over pure people management.

I'm the author of Dogma, an open-source ecosystem for building **distributed event-sourced applications in Go**. This project reflects my focus on building maintainable systems with clear architectural boundaries and a positive developer experience.

I care deeply about how software is built, both for the practical benefits to the team, and for the love of the craft itself.

### SKILLS + EXPERIENCE

#### LEADERSHIP & COLLABORATION

Pragmatic, people-focused engineer known for structured thinking, honest communication, and decisions that build trust and consensus.

- inclusive decision-making
- empathetic technical feedback
- cross-discipline mentoring
- goal-oriented conflict resolution
- alignment through clear reasoning
- calm incident leadership
- clarity in ambiguous contexts
- productivity in unfamiliar domains

#### TOOLING & AUTOMATION

Development of pipelines supporting fast-feedback, repeatable builds, and low-friction deployments.

- CI/CD pipelines
- zero-downtime deployments
- dev/prod parity strategies
- custom command-line tooling

[GIT](#) [GITHUB ACTIONS + API](#) [SLACK API](#)  
[ARGO CD](#) [DOCKER](#) [HELM](#) [MAKE](#) [BASH](#)

#### SYSTEMS ENGINEERING

Engineering of distributed and centralized systems with an emphasis on clarity, modularity, and long-term maintainability.

- message-based systems
- event-sourcing
- real-time & collaborative domains
- domain-driven design (DDD) & CQRS
- pragmatic microservices
- unit, integration & contract testing

[GO](#) [PHP](#) [HTML + CSS](#) [NODE.JS](#) [GRPC](#)  
[OPENAPI](#) [WEBSOCKETS](#) [SSE](#) [ADRS](#) [I18N](#)

#### PLATFORM & INFRASTRUCTURE

Design and operation of development and production infrastructure, valuing operability and developer experience.

- infrastructure as code (IaC) & GitOps
- internal developer portals
- secrets management
- custom Kubernetes controllers

[GIT](#) [KUBERNETES](#) [AWS](#) [KARPENTER](#)  
[TERRAFORM](#) [CROSSPLANE](#) [KCL](#)

#### DATABASES & STORAGE

Selection and integration of storage solutions to meet varying performance, durability, modelling and access requirements.

- relational & document modelling
- index & query optimisation
- event retention strategies
- read-model derivation

[POSTGRESQL](#) [MYSQL](#) [REDIS](#) [DYNAMODB](#)  
[SQLITE](#) [BBOLT](#) [S3](#)

#### OBSERVABILITY & OPERATIONS

Instrumentation and operational readiness practices to improve visibility, reliability, and response across distributed systems.

- structured logging & trace correlation
- metric collection
- automated health checks
- incident response & post-mortems

[OPENTELEMETRY](#) [AWS X-RAY](#) [PROMETHEUS](#)

*Additional experience includes C++, Python and C# and limited commercial experience with embedded systems and electronics hardware design.*

## DIALER.IO

OUTBOUND SALES PLATFORM

## ENGINEERING TEAM LEAD

NOV 2021 — PRESENT • 3.5 YEARS • FULLY REMOTE

## BETSECURE

IGAMING GEOLOCATION, COMPLIANCE &amp; FRAUD PREVENTION

## PRINCIPAL SOFTWARE ENGINEER

NOV 2021 — PRESENT • 3.5 YEARS • FULLY REMOTE

Shared **responsibility for technical and product leadership** across a startup delivering “Compliance as a Service” to online gambling operators. The platform enforced state-specific geolocation and regulatory controls as required by United States legislation. BetSecure shares a parent company with Codeworx, my previous employer.

**Recruited engineers to form cross-functional teams** with frontend, backend, mobile, and DevOps skillsets. Established remote mob programming as a core practice. Eliminated pull requests and asynchronous reviews in favour of continuous collaboration, reducing overhead and context switching.

**Directed the architecture and implementation of backend systems**, including geolocation services, API gateways, and compliance logic. Services were built in Go using an **event-sourced architecture, following CQRS and domain-driven design principles**.

- mentored engineers in distributed design, event-sourcing, read-model projection, and CQRS
- guided architecture across multiple autonomous teams
- interpreted regulatory documents to ensure systems adhere to state-specific compliance rules
- built a Kubernetes-based developer platform with on-demand environments provisioned via Slack
- developed tools for in-cluster development using real domains, certificates and cloud services
- implemented SSO support for multiple IdPs, covering internal platforms, developer tooling, and customer-facing products
- led ongoing development of Dogma in collaboration with Codeworx engineers.

GO DDD CQRS NODE.JS YARN GRPC OPENAPI POSTGRESQL POSTGIS GEOJSON DYNAMODB KUBERNETES HELM ARGO CD TELEPRESENCE  
AWS TERRAFORM GIT OAUTH + OIDC JOSE/JWT OKTA

## CODEWORX

ONLINE POKER &amp; SPORTS BETTING

## SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT MANAGER

DEC 2008 — NOV 2021 • 13 YEARS • IN-OFFICE / HYBRID-REMOTE

Held **long-term responsibility for the architecture, quality, and continuity** of backend systems supporting the company's online poker and sports betting platforms. **Led the team through a major strategic shift** from a large PHP monolith to a **distributed architecture in Go**, built on CQRS and event-sourcing principles.

**Recruited and mentored engineers**, established engineering practices, and provided **hands-on technical leadership** as the company shifted from product ownership to delivering software for affiliated businesses.

- introduced unit testing, automated builds, and code coverage reporting to PHP codebases
- advocated for company-wide move from Subversion to Git, improving branching performance and developer experience
- led early adoption of Composer to modularise shared code
- authored Recoil, an asynchronous coroutine library for PHP 7
- championed adoption of Go to overcome limitations in PHP's concurrency and process model
- developed Dogma, an opinionated event-sourcing framework for Go

GO PHP HTML + CSS JAVASCRIPT NODE.JS NPM COMPOSER PHPUNIT MYSQL POSTGRESQL COUCHDB GRPC REST WEBSOCKETS DOCKER  
GIT BAMBOO JENKINS LINUX APACHE NGINX

## SOFTWARE DEVELOPER

JUL 2006 — DEC 2008 • 2.5 YEARS • IN-OFFICE

Member of a team of PHP developers responsible for the backoffice and player-facing features of the company's online poker and casino gaming platform, which powered *Poker.com* during the height of poker's global popularity.

**Fostered cross-team collaboration** with the engineers responsible for the poker gameplay components, enabling deeper integration with backoffice systems. This empowered operations staff to configure complex gameplay and promotional aspects without developer involvement, **significantly reducing toil and increasing operational flexibility**.

- designed and optimized schemas and queries across a multi-terabyte MySQL replication set
- built highly-tuned materialized views using triggers and stored procedures
- addressed UX challenges posed by the eventually consistent nature of replicated systems

PHP HTML + CSS JAVASCRIPT MYSQL REST SOAP LINUX FREEBSD APACHE SVN

## MANAGED SOLUTIONS

IT SERVICES & INTERNET SERVICE PROVIDER

## SOFTWARE DEVELOPER

FEB 2005 — JUL 2006 • 1.5 YEARS • IN-OFFICE

Streamlined daily operations for field technicians by **developing an on-site job management system** incorporating scheduling, time tracking, and invoicing features across desktop and early smartphone devices.

**Worked largely independently** with technical guidance from a skilled Python developer. Collaborated with the general manager, acting as product owner, to keep features aligned with established business processes.

- quickly learned Python and its web-development ecosystem
- applied prior MySQL experience to PostgreSQL schema & query design
- developed branded mini-sites for conference attendee & speaker registration

PYTHON PHP HTML + CSS JAVASCRIPT POSTGRESQL LINUX APACHE SVN

## OZ SERVERS

WEB HOSTING & DEDICATED SERVERS

## LEAD SOFTWARE DEVELOPER

2002 — FEB 2005 • 3.5 YEARS • IN-OFFICE

Enabled the company's expansion into dedicated hosting and co-location by **leading the development of a comprehensive business operations platform** that supported all aspects of daily operations, including ordering, billing, issue tracking, DNS zone management, network automation, and asset tracking.

- implemented a query caching layer to improve responsiveness on commodity hardware
- developed strategies to ensure data integrity in MySQL v3, which lacked transactional support
- integrated with external systems such as routers and hardware power control devices

PHP HTML + CSS JAVASCRIPT C++ MYSQL LINUX APACHE IPTABLES DNS DHCP

*The platform remained in active use for many years, supporting business operations until the company's acquisition by Servers Australia in 2017.*

## OPEN SOURCE

### DOGMA

EVENT-SOURCING FRAMEWORK FOR GO

Dogma is a comprehensive set of tools for building distributed event-sourced applications in Go.

 dogmatiq/dogma

### RECOIL

ASYNCHRONOUS COROUTINES FOR PHP 7

Recoil provides a generator-based syntax for expressing asynchronous logic in a familiar imperative manner.

 recoilphp/recoil

### GRIT

CLI FOR MANAGEMENT OF GIT CLONES

Grit clones and indexes your Git repositories, with fast directory switching & autocomplete.

 jmalloc/grit

EDUCATION

DIPLOMA OF INFORMATION TECHNOLOGY  
SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT

QANTM COLLEGE (SAE), BRISBANE • 2001

CERTIFICATE III IN ELECTRONICS

SOUTH BANK TAFE, BRISBANE • 1998 — 1999

REFERENCES

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